

Almanac 47 for Free42

SwissMicros DM42 / DM42n with the stock (Free42) firmware — user manual

The full Almanac 47 of the C47 — the Sun, the Moon, the planets and the 58 navigation stars, 9 views — converted to Free42 3.3 with the DM42 graphics extension (the whole 400 × 240 screen). The menu, the screens and the values are the same as on the C47: in the Free42 core (SwissMicros source, release 3.3.10) each screen was compared pixel by pixel with the C47 version, and the text page line by line.

It supports, and does not replace, the Nautical Almanac. Always cross-check the values.

Copyright © 2026 Victor Valdes. Free software under the GNU General Public License v3.0 or later. It comes with NO WARRANTY. Written with the help of AI (Claude, by Anthropic); the results were checked against the C47 version, which was checked against JPL Horizons, USNO data and the Nautical Almanac.

1. What you need

- A **DM42n** (recommended) or DM42 with the SwissMicros stock firmware (DM42 3.26 = Free42 3.3.10 or later). The DM42n has ample memory; on the old DM42 the full version with the Moon and planets is tight.
- Free42 on a PC or phone has only the 131 × 16 HP-42S screen: NAV runs there, but you see only the top left corner of each screen. Use the calculator for the views.

2. Files (build/free42)

File	What it is
NAVFULL_F42.raw	the program NAV and its routines: the screen builds up as it is drawn (Free42 way)
NAVFULL_F42_RLCD.raw	the same, the screen appears complete at once (C47 way) — load this one OR the other
NAVINIT_F42_FULL.raw	INIT: the series matrices, valid 2000–2050
NAVINIT_F42_FAST.raw	INIT: fitted series for 2026–2030 (smaller, faster)
*.txt	the same programs as text (Free42 on a PC: Paste in PRGM mode)

3. Loading and first start

- Connect the calculator by USB (it appears as a disk) and copy the .raw files into the PROGRAMS folder.
- On the calculator: **SETUP → Load Program**, load NAVINIT_F42_FULL.raw (or _FAST).
- **XEQ "INIT"**: it builds the matrices and shows MATRICES READY. Then delete INIT (GTO "INIT", CLP): the matrices stay.
- Load NAVFULL_F42.raw (or NAVFULL_F42_RLCD.raw) and **XEQ "NAV"**.

4. Starting NAV

NAV asks four numbers with INPUT (R/S keeps the value shown); the formats are in the message line first:

Input	Meaning	Example
DATE	UT date, YYYY.MMDD	2026.0926
UTC	UT, HH.MMSS	14.57
LAT	latitude DD.MMm, south negative	25.20 = 25° 20' N
LON	longitude DDD.MMm, west negative	55.12 = 55° 12' E

- **Time is UT (UT1)**: for a sight timed in UTC add DUT1 (under 0.9 s) — as in the almanac.
- **Signs**: latitude N +, S –; longitude E +, W –.

Then NAV switches to the 400 × 240 graphics mode (GrMod 3), computes the sky (the SINKING....ABOUT box shows meanwhile) and draws the menu. 0 on the menu ends NAV and sets the normal screen again (GrMod 0).

ALMANAC 47 VALID 2026-2030
26-09-2026 14:57 UT DR N 25 20.0 E 55 12.0

1 ALMANAC	6 SPLIT
2 CHART	7 ANIM
3 TEXT	8 ALLSKY
4 SKY	9 INFO
5 SMALL	0 END

KEY A NUMBER + MENU UP DOWN 1 HOUR

DOES NOT REPLACE THE NAUTICAL ALMANAC

5. Keys

Key	On the menu	On a view
1 - 9	the item is highlighted and its view is drawn	—
+	—	back to the menu
▲ / ▼	one hour later / earlier	the same view one hour later / earlier
0	end of NAV (screen and stack cleared)	—
R/S, EXIT	stop the program	stop the program

6. The views

26 Sep 2026 14:57 UT, 25° 20' N 055° 12' E, as drawn by Free42.

26-09-2026 14:57 UT		DR	N 25	20.0	E 55	12.0	S
BODY		GHA		DEC		HC	ZN
☉	ARIES	229	40.8				
	SUN	46	25.7	S 1	24.5	11 06.4	273.7
☾	MOON	228	27.2	N 3	37.2	13 52.9	092.6
♀	VENUS	16	40.1	S 20	19.3	6 36.8	243.8
♄	SATURN	217	39.7	N 2	13.1	3 32.1	089.2
★ 37	ARCTURUS	15	27.7	N 19	02.7	24 59.7	280.2
★ 49	VEGA	310	13.1	N 38	48.8	75 46.1	342.6
★ 51	ALTAIR	291	39.3	N 8	56.5	69 23.0	140.4
★ 42	ANTARES	341	55.1	S 26	29.5	27 00.7	217.3
★ 56	FOMALHAUT	244	53.4	S 29	28.7	10 35.9	130.0
NAUT TWI 01:20		15:01		MOON 100% FULL			
RISE/SET 02:09		14:12		AGE 15.5 DAYS			
MER PASS 08:11		SD 16.0		HP 57.7 SD 15.7			

DOES NOT REPLACE THE NAUTICAL ALMANAC

1 ALMANAC: GHA, Dec, Hc, Zn of 10 bodies; twilight, rise/set, mer. pass, Moon phase, HP, SD. A negative Hc is white on black.

26-09-2026 14:57 UT DR N 25 20.0 E 55 12.0	GHA 3 10° 13.1' DEC N 38° 48.8'
ARIES 229° 40.8' S	51 ALTAIR HC 69° 23.0' ZN 140.4°
★ SUN HC -11° 06.4' ZN 273.7°	GHA 29 1° 39.3' DEC N 8° 56.5'
GHA 46° 25.7' DEC S 1° 24.5'	42 ANTARES HC 27° 00.7' ZN 217.3°
MOON HC 13° 52.9' ZN 092.6°	GHA 34 1° 55.1' DEC S 26° 29.5'
GHA 228° 27.2' DEC N 3° 37.2'	56 FOMALHAUT HC 10° 35.9' ZN 130.0°
VENUS HC 6° 36.8' ZN 243.8°	GHA 244° 53.4' DEC S 29° 28.7'
GHA 16° 40.1' DEC S 20° 19.3'	53 DENEBC HC 61° 13.8' ZN 039.3°
SATURN HC 3° 32.1' ZN 089.2°	GHA 279° 05.4' DEC N 45° 22.8'
GHA 217° 39.7' DEC N 2° 13.1'	NAUT TWI 01:20 15:01 RISE/SET 02:09 14:12
37 ARCTURUS HC 24° 59.7' ZN 280.2°	MER PASS 08:11 SUN SD 16.0
GHA 15° 27.7' DEC N 19° 02.7'	MOON 100% FULL AGE 15.5 DAYS
49 VEGA HC 75° 46.1' ZN 342.6°	MOON HP 57.7 MOON SD 15.7

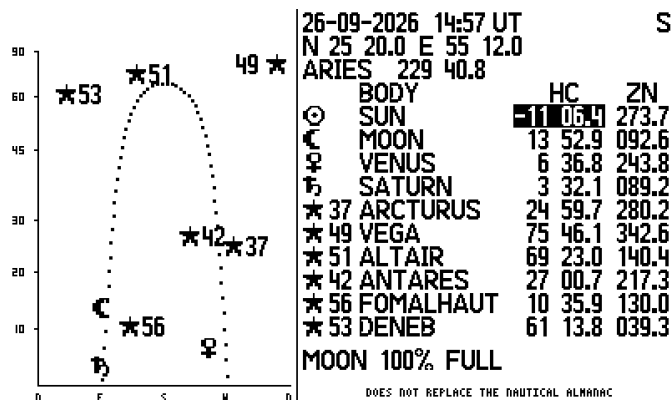
+ MENU

3 TEXT: the almanac page as text, drawn with the small font; the lines are also in R50 ... (Free42 has no register browser). + (3 s each). back to the menu.

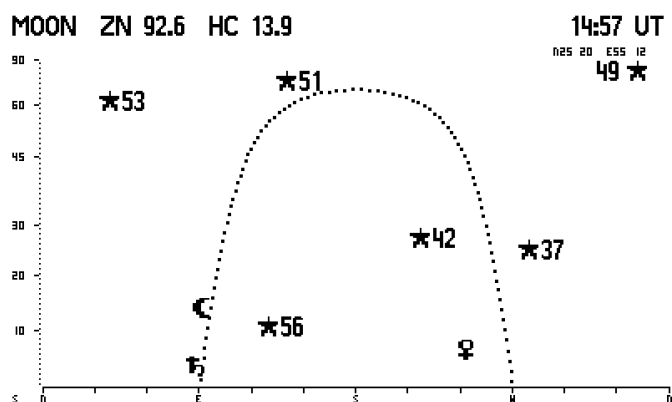
26-09-2026 14:57 UT		DR	N 25	20.0	E 55	12.0	S
BODY		GHA		DEC		HC	ZN
☉ ARIES		229	40.8				
☉	SUN	46	25.7	S 1	24.5	11 06.4	273.7
☾	MOON	228	27.2	N 3	37.2	13 52.9	092.6
♀	VENUS	16	40.1	S 20	19.3	6 36.8	243.8
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MER PASS 08:11 SD 16.0				HP 57.7 SD 15.7			

DOES NOT REPLACE THE NAUTICAL ALMANAC

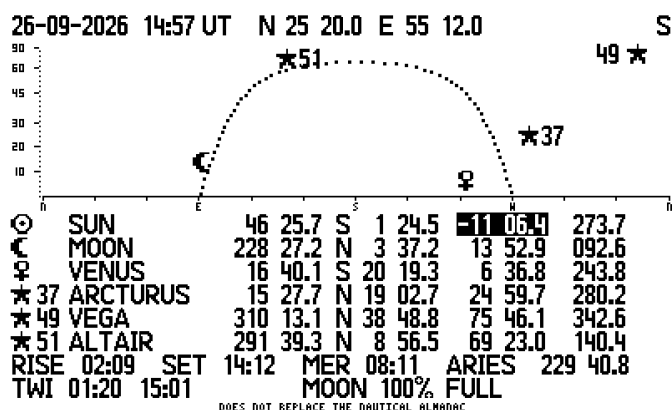
5 SMALL: short almanac.



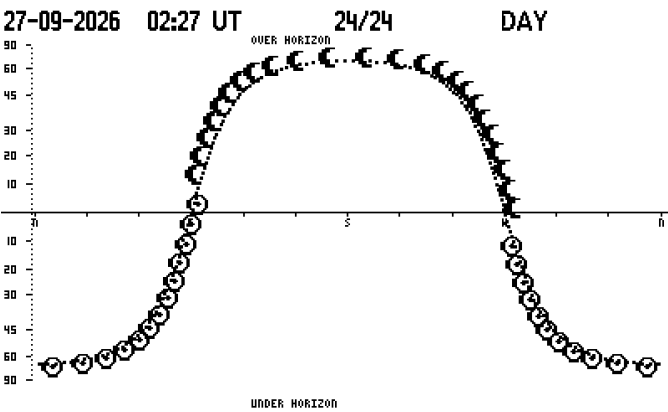
2 CHART: the sky (Hc up, Zn across, the celestial equator dotted) and the Hc/Zn table.



4 SKY: full-screen chart; the top line names each body in turn



6 SPLIT: chart on top, short almanac below.



7 ANIM: the Sun and the Moon over 12 hours (24 frames, 1 s each).

ALMANAC 47 - INFO

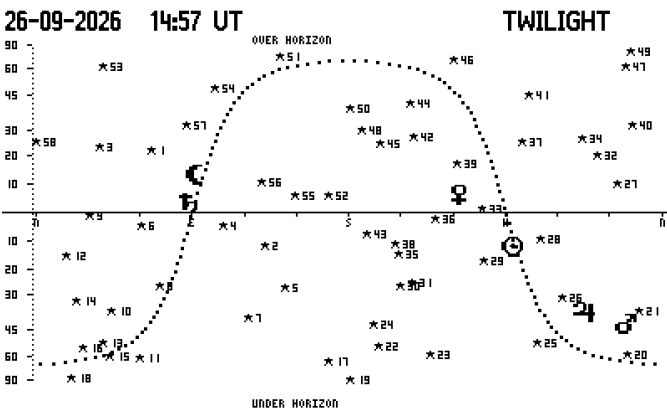
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COPYRIGHT 2026 VICTOR VALDES
FREE SOFTWARE: GNU GPL V3 OR LATER

NO WARRANTY - IT MAY HAVE BUGS AND
ALWAYS CROSS-CHECK THE VALUES
WITH THE NAUTICAL ALMANAC

THE ANTS ARE WAITING FOR A FLAG
+ MENU

DOES NOT REPLACE THE NAUTICAL ALMANAC

9 INFO: repository, licence, no warranty, cross-check.



8 ALLSKY: the whole sky, over and under the horizon; DAY / TWILIGHT / NIGHT.

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The SINKING....ABOUT box while the calculator works, with the ants (flag 97, below).

7. How the screen appears: NAVFULL_F42 and NAVFULL_F42_RLCD

Free42 sends every drawing step to the LCD at once, so with **NAVFULL_F42** each screen builds up in front of you (the stars of SKY appear one by one), and the SINKING box is cleared as soon as the next view starts to draw. The C47 shows its screen only at a PAUSE, a key press or the end, so there a view appears complete, at once, and the box stays until it is ready.

NAVFULL_F42_RLCD does it the C47 way with the DM42 variable RefLCD: 0 STO "RefLCD" (no LCD update while NAV computes and draws), -1 STO "RefLCD" (one update) where the C47 program shows its screen, and 7 (normal) when NAV ends. If you stop it with R/S or EXIT and the screen stays frozen, key **7 STO "RefLCD"**.

8. The ants

The ants live in NAV as on the C47, but they wait for **flag 97** (the HP-42S flag 47 is a system flag): SF 97 and press a view number, + or an arrow.

9. What is different inside (the screens are the same)

- AGRAPH draws the ALPHA register (8-pixel columns, bit 0 at the top): the fonts are strings of column bytes; the C47 drawing modes (OR, set, clear, XOR = GRMOD 0-3) are the HP-42S AGRAPH flags 34 and 35.
- PIXEL goes through a routine that converts the C47 coordinates (row 0 at the bottom) to the DM42 ones (row 1 at the top).
- Keys (GETKEY / GETKEYA) are translated to the C47 key codes; pauses use TIME; strings use XSTR, APPEND, HEAD; the date is computed (Free42 has no C47 date functions). NAV sets SIZE 100 (R00-R99).
- Built with tools/build_free42.py from the C47 programs; tested with tools/f42 (the Free42 core with the DM42 graphics, binary arithmetic). Tested on a DM42n with the stock firmware by the author.